

IMAGES IN CLINICAL MEDICINE

Torsion of a Mature Cystic Ovarian Teratoma

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A 59-YEAR-OLD WOMAN PRESENTED WITH A 1-DAY HISTORY OF SUDDEN-ONSET, SHARP PAIN IN HER LEFT lower abdomen. Physical examination was notable for tenderness to palpation and a firm, nonmobile mass in the left lower quadrant. On pelvic examination, there was cervical motion tenderness. Although ultrasonography is the ideal imaging method for assessment of adnexal masses, magnetic resonance imaging of the abdomen and pelvis was performed in this case. A cystic mass measuring 11.9 cm by 9.0 cm by 12.5 cm was seen in the left adnexa (T2-weighted, fat-saturated sequence; sagittal view). Multiple free-floating, hypoattenuating nodules were seen within the mass. This finding — known as the sack-of-marbles sign — represents globules of sebum or fat within a cystic lesion. There was also twisting of the ovarian pedicle — a finding known as the whirlpool sign — indicating ovarian torsion (arrows). A diagnosis of torsion of a mature cystic ovarian teratoma was confirmed during a laparotomy in which the cyst, left ovary, and left fallopian tube were removed. Sebaceous material, fat, and hair were found when the resected cyst was incised. Histopathological findings were consistent with a mature cystic teratoma with extensive hemorrhagic necrosis. The patient recovered well and had no recurrence over 10 years of follow-up.

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